

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Azure and M365 Security | Zero Trust Architecture | Identity and Access Management | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior cyber security engineer with over five years of progressive experience designing, implementing, and managing security controls across Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365 (M365) environments. I have a strong technical foundation in Zero Trust architecture, Identity and Access Management (IAM), vulnerability management, security monitoring, and incident response, with hands-on experience delivering enterprise-scale security programmes across education and technology sectors. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and have worked closely with managed Security Operations Centre (SOC) providers to detect, triage, and respond to escalated security incidents. I bring deep knowledge of Microsoft security technologies including Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), and Conditional Access, alongside strong governance experience aligned to NIST, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, and CIS Controls frameworks.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Azure and M365 Security Controls:** Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management - SIEM), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender suite; design and implementation of security controls for Azure and M365 workloads
- **Zero Trust Architecture:** Conditional Access policies, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management (PIM); Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) - strong
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID, Azure Active Directory, Group Policy, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM); user lifecycle management, access reviews, role-based access control (RBAC)
- **Security Monitoring and Incident Response:** SIEM alert triage and investigation, Kusto Query Language (KQL) for threat detection and hunting; NIST SP 800-61 incident response lifecycle; MITRE ATT&CK framework
- **Vulnerability Management and Security Assessments:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; vulnerability scanning, risk prioritisation, and remediation tracking
- **Endpoint and Device Management:** CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, Tanium; 8,000-user deployment experience
- **Security Governance and Compliance:** ISO 27001, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, Cyber Essentials Plus; policy development, risk registers, security standards documentation
- **Email and Identity Security:** Mimecast; anti-phishing, DLP, impersonation protection; security awareness training
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell; SOAR playbook development, operational reporting, and automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Design, implement, and manage security controls for Microsoft Azure and M365 environments across an estate of approximately 8,000 users, ensuring alignment to Zero Trust principles and security best practices
- Lead the development and implementation of Zero Trust security architectures, including Conditional Access policies, MFA enforcement, and Privileged Identity Management (PIM) within Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory)

- Manage and maintain Identity and Access Management (IAM) systems and processes, overseeing user provisioning, access reviews, RBAC, and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) governance
- Monitor security systems and investigate escalated security events from a managed Security Operations Centre (SOC), conducting triage and response using Microsoft Sentinel SIEM and Defender XDR
- Write KQL queries in Microsoft Sentinel for advanced detection, threat hunting, investigation workbooks, and scheduled analytics rules across identity, endpoint, email, and network data sources
- Conduct vulnerability assessments and security testing using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); coordinate and track remediation activities with IT infrastructure teams
- Lead incident response activities following NIST SP 800-61, managing the full lifecycle from detection through eradication, recovery, and post-incident review; map adversary techniques to MITRE ATT&CK
- Develop and maintain security policies, standards, and procedures; provide technical security guidance and support to IT teams and business stakeholders
- Evaluate and recommend new security technologies; stay current with evolving threat landscapes, regulatory requirements, and Microsoft security roadmap developments
- Lead security awareness campaigns and deliver training to staff, building a security-conscious culture across the organisation

Cyber Security Analyst - Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Designed and implemented Microsoft Azure and M365 security controls, including Conditional Access policies, MFA, and identity protection settings, significantly reducing the risk of account compromise
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) and Group Policy; administered role-based access control, privileged account governance via BeyondTrust PAM, and identity lifecycle processes
- Operated Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, building custom KQL analytics rules, workbooks, and incident response runbooks; investigated and escalated security alerts across identity, endpoint, and email telemetry
- Deployed and maintained CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the UAL estate; configured prevention policies, sensor management, and endpoint health monitoring
- Ran vulnerability management assessments using Tenable.io and Nessus, coordinating patch prioritisation and risk remediation with IT teams aligned to CIS Controls
- Supported the delivery of Cyber Essentials Plus certification, coordinating technical evidence across endpoint protection, firewall management, patching, and access control domains
- Contributed to security policy development and risk register maintenance aligned to ISO 27001 and NIST Cybersecurity Framework
- Provided technical guidance to IT colleagues on secure configuration of Microsoft Azure, M365, and cloud identity services

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

- Implemented and managed endpoint security controls, identity and access management processes, and infrastructure security in a cloud-first SaaS environment
- Configured MFA, SSO, and user access management for internal systems; conducted access reviews and managed the joiner, mover, and leaver (JML) process
- Performed vulnerability scans, maintained an asset inventory, and supported patch management and configuration hardening
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities, including risk assessment, policy documentation, and control evidence collection
- Bridged security engineering and IT operations, ensuring security requirements were embedded in infrastructure design and operational processes

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and rolled out a comprehensive Zero Trust architecture at UAL, enforcing Conditional Access, MFA, and Privileged Identity Management across Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) for 8,000 users

- Built a Microsoft Sentinel SIEM detection library of over 40 custom KQL analytics rules, covering identity compromise, endpoint threats, email-based attacks, and data exfiltration scenarios
- Integrated BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) into UAL's identity governance framework, eliminating standing privileged access for the majority of administrative accounts
- Led vulnerability management programme combining Tenable.io assessments and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), enabling continuous risk-prioritised remediation aligned to CIS Controls
- Secured UAL's Cyber Essentials Plus certification by coordinating technical evidence across endpoint, network, identity, and patch management controls
- Established a security policy framework at UAL aligned to ISO 27001 and NIST CSF, providing a governance foundation across the organisation's digital estate

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (Bedford/London/UK)